

# HTML5: A Powerful Tool for Mobile Application Development

An increasing number of people are seeing the Web on a mobile screen. Soon, they will outnumber desktop users. This has led to a need for better apps that are platform and device independent. HTML5 technology fits admirably into the scheme of things for creating such apps.



**A**ndroid and iOS have been dominating the mobile app-making business, while other native app-building operating systems such as Windows and BlackBerry are trying hard to catch up. The question that always arises is whether a business requires both a website and a mobile application. Meanwhile, there have been innovations in the new methodologies that will take over the present market. HTML5 is one such powerful and feature-rich tool to develop Web as well as mobile applications. It also reduces the functionality gap between mobile sites and applications. Many organisations, faced with deploying mobile apps across multiple platforms, are turning to HTML5 mobile application development to streamline the implementation of apps, and reduce costs and complexity.

HTML5 is the main domain for most of the cross-

platform application development tools such as Apache Cordova, Rhodes and many others. These tools can be used to create applications which use native features such as GPS, camera, locations, contacts, etc. It also gives flexibility to the developer in developing a UX, using scripts and much more. Besides, these apps can be easily deployed using open source JavaScript tools. In May 2010, Google announced the creation of its Chrome Web Store, a marketplace for Web applications that are built with standard Web technologies (HTML5, CSS and JavaScript), and can be accessed and used by anyone using a Web browser that supports these technologies.

## What is an HTML5 application?

HTML5 is not only used in mobile websites but also in mobile apps on mobile OSs (Ubuntu Touch, Firefox OS,